Testing Relic Mechanics



Background:

About Slay the Spire 2(STS2):

Slay the Spire 2 is a highly anticipated roguelike deck-building game developed by Mega Crit and released in Early Access in March 2026. Building on the massive success of its 2019 predecessor, it combines deep strategic card combat with procedurally generated paths.

Players select one of five characters—three returning favorites (The Ironclad, The Silent, and The Defect) and two brand new additions (The Necrobinder and The Regent). Each character has a unique starting deck and a specific pool of cards to draft from. The core gameplay loop involves navigating multiple acts of a randomly generated Spire. Along the way, players face tactical turn-based battles where enemy intents are fully telegraphed, allowing for precise decision-making.

Between combats, players encounter "? events," visit merchants to buy cards, potions, relics or to remove cards, and rest at campfires to heal or upgrade their cards. A major new feature in the sequel is a cooperative mode that supports up to four players working together, modifying how combat and character abilities interact.

What are Relics in Slay the Spire 2:

In the Slay the Spire universe, Relics are crucial items for players. They provide permanent, passive bonuses, penalties or both, for the duration of a run. Once obtained, they

can only be in certain rare events, and their effects shape a player's long-term strategy and deck building.

How Relics are Obtained:

Relics are primarily earned by defeating Elite enemies and opening treasure chests. They can also be purchased from the Merchant using gold or acquired through specific, often risky, map events.

Relic Rarity Tiers:

There are over 250 Relics available, categorized by rarity:

- **Common:** Frequent drops providing consistent, foundational value.
- **Uncommon:** More specialized items that typically support specific deck archetypes.
- **Rare:** Highly powerful items capable of defining an entire run.
- **Ancient:** High-impact Relics that often fundamentally alter core mechanics, usually with a significant trade-off.
- **Shop & Event:** Relics exclusively found at Merchants or during map events, respectively.

Test Suite

Test Case 1: Snecko Eye confused not overriding card Creation

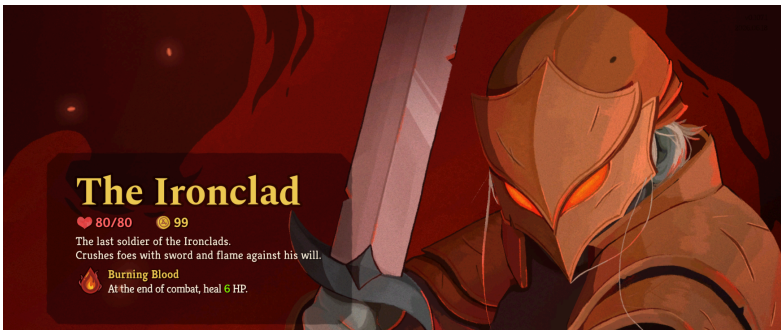


Reason for testing:

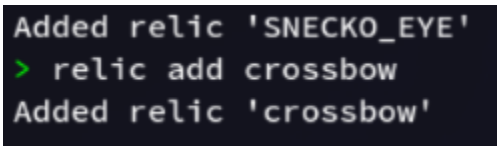
Snecko Eye applies debuff when combat starts, but Crossbow creates an attack card (doesn't draw) and sets its value to 0 on that turn. We need to check if that card has its value altered when created and then altered when it's drawn.

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character.



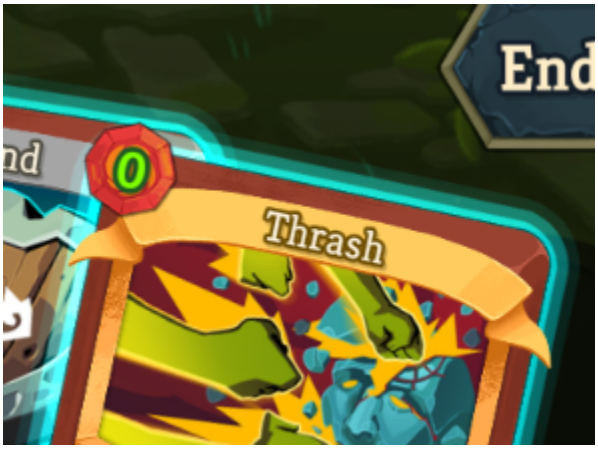
2. Apply the following commands
    a. relic add SNECKO_EYE
    b. relic add crossbow



3. Choose a combat room



4. Observe that card added by crossbow remains cost 0



5. Finish turn

6. Observe that new card added by crossbow remains cost 0
7. Go through turns until one of the cards added by crossbow returns and observe that the cards have changed values



Expected Result:

A card will be added and its value will be set to 0, other cards' values are randomized from 1 to 3 in the first round. Later on the card, when drawn, needs to have its value randomized from 1 to 3.

Test Case 2: Snecko not overruling 2



Reason for testing:

Snecko Eye applies debuff when combat starts, but Choices Paradox Creates a card (doesn't draw) and applies retain. We need to check if that card has its energy cost altered between turns.

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character
2. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic add SNECKO_EYES
    b. relic add CHOICES_PARADOX

```
> relic add snecko_eye
Added relic 'snecko_eye'
> relic add CHOICES_PARADOX
Added relic 'CHOICES_PARADOX'
```

3. Choose a combate room
4. Observe card created and its cost



5. Finish turn without playing added card



Expected Result:

Confused effects will be applied, but the chosen card will not have its value changed, as it wasn't drawn.

Test Case 3: Artifact Interaction - Bag of Marbles and Red Mask



Reasons for Testing:

Bag of Marbles applies Vulnerable on enemies and Red Mask applies Weak on Enemies. We need to see if the order that they are acquired

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run and choose The Ironclad for character.
2. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
    b. relic add RED_MASK
    c. fight CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL

```
> relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
Added relic 'BAG_OF_MARBLES'
> relic add RED_MASK
Added relic 'RED_MASK'
> fight CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL
Jumped to encounter: 'CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL'
```

3. Observe that Cubex Construct has lost artifact and now has weak applied.



4. Apply the following commands:
    a. relic remove BAG_OF_MARBLES
    b. relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
    c. fight CUBEX_CONSTRUC_NORMAL

```
> relic remove BAG_OF_MARBLES
Relic removed!
> relic add BAG_OF_MARBLES
Added relic 'BAG_OF_MARBLES'
> fight CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL
Jumped to encounter: 'CUBEX_CONSTRUCT_NORMAL'
```

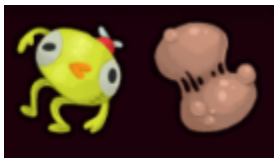
5. Observe that Cubex Construct has lost artifact and now has vulnerable applied



Expected Result:

Bag of Marbles triggers first, and its Vulnerable effect is negated by the Cubex Construct's Artifact. Red Mask triggers second, successfully applying the Weak debuff. The Cubex Construct starts the combat with Weak applied and 0 Artifact.

Test Case 4: Bing Bong and Clone



Reasons for Testing:

Bing Bong adds a copy of any card added to the deck, we need to check if it applies to the cards created from the Clone enchantment

Steps:

1. Start a singleplayer run
2. Choose Ironclad for character
3. Apply the following commands
    a. relic add BING_BONG
    b. relic add PAELS_GROWTH (choose a strike to clone)
    c. room RestSite

```
> relic add BING_BONG
Added relic 'BING_BONG'
> relic add PAELS_GROWTH
Added relic 'PAELS_GROWTH'
> room RestSite
Jumped to room: 'RestSite'
> room RestSite
```

4. Choose clone on rest site
5. Apply the command “room RestSite”
6. Choose clone

Expected Result:

Instead of only one Card being added to the deck on the first clone, two cards are added, and on the second clone 6 cards are added to the deck.


1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.
1
Strike
Attack
Deal 6 damage.